CJALSONS WITH BROWN BUTTER AND CINNAMON

REGION	SERVES	TOTAL TIME
North	**4-6**	**2 h plus the dough rest**

INGREDIENTS

348 g	Ricotta
57 g	Smoked ricotta for the filling, coarsely grated
64 g	Granny Smith apple, peeled and finely grated
29 g	Dried pear, finely chopped
15 g	Golden raisins, finely chopped
28 g	Montasio cheese, finely grated
1 orange	Orange peel, pith removed and finely chopped
1 lemon	Lemon peel, pith removed and finely chopped
1/4 tsp	Cinnamon for the filling, freshly ground
1/2 tsp	Natural cocoa powder for the filling
quantity not given	Salt
quantity not given	Black pepper
1 batch	Egg dough
150 g	Unsalted butter, cold and cubed
1 stick	Cinnamon stick to finish, grated, or ground cinnamon
quantity not given	Natural cocoa powder to finish
114 g	Smoked ricotta to finish, in one piece

METHOD

1. Pass the ricotta through a tamis or a fine-mesh strainer into a bowl.
2. Fold in the smoked ricotta, apple, pear, raisins, Montasio, both citrus peels, the 1/4 tsp cinnamon and the 1/2 tsp cocoa until the mixture is even.
3. Season with salt and black pepper. Aim for properly seasoned. Cover it and refrigerate until you need it.
4. Make 48 to 60 cjalsons from the egg dough and the filling.
5. Salt a large pot of water heavily and bring it to a boil over high heat.
6. Set a small saucepan over medium heat and cook 114 g of the butter 3 to 4 minutes, to just past golden brown. Take it off the heat. This brown butter goes over the plates at the end.
7. Drop the cjalsons in and bring the water down to a gentle simmer rather than a rolling boil, since the filling can break over high heat. Cook 2 to 3 minutes. They are done when the thickest seal has gone tender.
8. While they cook, set a large saute pan over medium heat with 2 ladles of pasta water (115 g) and the remaining butter, and swirl them together to emulsify.
9. Lift the pasta across with a spider or pasta basket and swirl about 30 seconds, turning the pieces with a spoon so all sides are coated.
10. Plate the pasta and spoon brown butter over each serving. Dust with cinnamon, then with the barest fall of cocoa, sifted through a fine sieve, a baker's wand or a shaker. Grate the 114 g piece of smoked ricotta over the top and finish with black pepper.

SHAPING



1



2



3



4

NOTES

Simmer rather than boil. The filling is soft and the seams open if the water moves hard.
The 150 g of butter splits in two. 114 g browns in a small pan for drizzling and the remainder emulsifies with pasta water into the pan sauce.
Cocoa goes on in a trace through a strainer. A little travels a very long way here.
Sweet versions of the dish lean on dried fruit, chocolate, ricotta and biscotti. Savory ones lean on foraged herbs, ricotta, nuts and spices. This one sits between the two.
The spelling moves around the Carnic Alps along with the recipe. Cjarsons and cialzons name the same pasta.

FILLING

Ricotta, Apple and Dried Fruit Filling

INGREDIENTS

348 g	Ricotta
57 g	Smoked ricotta, coarsely grated
64 g	Granny Smith apple, peeled and finely grated
29 g	Dried pear, finely chopped
15 g	Golden raisins, finely chopped
28 g	Montasio cheese, finely grated
1 orange	Orange peel, pith removed and finely chopped
1 lemon	Lemon peel, pith removed and finely chopped
1/4 tsp	Cinnamon, freshly ground
1/2 tsp	Natural cocoa powder
quantity not given	Salt
quantity not given	Black pepper

METHOD

1. Pass the ricotta through a tamis or a fine-mesh strainer into a bowl.
2. Add the smoked ricotta, apple, pear, raisins, Montasio, both citrus peels, the cinnamon and the cocoa. Fold everything together until it is evenly mixed.
3. Season with salt and black pepper. Aim for properly seasoned. Cover it and refrigerate until you are ready to pipe.

NOTES

The mixture sits deliberately between sweet and savory. Apple, dried fruit and cocoa pull one way, the two ricottas, the Montasio and the seasoning pull the other.
Pass the ricotta through a tamis first. That step is what gets the filling smooth enough to pipe through a 1/2-inch tip.
Both peels go in with the pith stripped off, which keeps the citrus aromatic rather than bitter.
Only 1/2 tsp of cocoa goes in. It is a background note against the fruit, not a chocolate flavor.
The mixture is loose and delicate. Pasta filled with it wants a gentle simmer, not a rolling boil.

DATE ___ / ___ / ___ RATING ___ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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